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2026 elections - Term limits shake up runs for Senate, Assembly

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There are 32 legislative races — eight state Senate and 24 Assembly seats — on the Nov. 3 ballot where Los Angeles County voters will help decide the winner during this year's general election.

Eight of these races have no incumbent running.

In the state Senate, they include the 24th and 34th districts, where outgoing Sens. Ben Allen and Tom Umberg are facing term limits. Also, in the 26th District, Sen. María Elena Durazo did not seek reelection but instead ran for, and won, a seat on the L.A. County Board of Supervisors in June.

In the Assembly, five races feature no incumbent. That's because Assemblymembers Tom Lackey (District 34), Jacqui Irwin (District 42), Mike Gipson (District 65), Al Muratsuchi (District 66) and Sharon Quirk-Silva (District 67) are termed out.

There are also two races where the incumbent is running unopposed: Assemblymembers Mark Gonzalez and Tina McKinnor, who represent the 54th and 61st districts, respectively. Both are Democrats.

In many of these races, a candidate captured more than 50% of the vote in the June primary election. But for state legislative races, the top two vote-getters, regardless of political party, move on to the general election, even if one candidate received the majority of the vote in the primary.

Below is a breakdown of L.A. County's legislative races.

20th State Senate District

Sen. Caroline Menjivar, a Democrat seeking a second term, is running against Republican Tony Rodriguez, a construction recruitment manager.

22nd State Senate District

Democratic Sen. Susan Rubio, going for a third term, is facing Republican Mike Netter, a small business owner.

24th State Senate District

West Hollywood Councilmember John Erickson and media consultant Brian Goldsmith are embroiled in one of the most expensive legislative races this cycle to see which Democrat will succeed term-limited Sen. Ben Allen, D-Santa Monica.

Erickson, who is chief of staff at Alliance for a Better Community, an L.A.-based organization whose mission is to advance social, economic and racial equity and justice, was first elected to the West Hollywood City Council in 2020.

Goldsmith, a Beverly Hills resident, has never been elected to office, though he worked on Hillary Clinton's 2000 U.S. Senate campaign and advised Pete Buttigieg during his 2020 presidential run.

Since the June primary election and up through mid-October the two candidates raised more than $3.2 million

combined while outside “independent expenditure” groups poured at least another $5.8 million into the race.

26th State Senate District

This race pits Sara Hernandez, an affordable housing advocate and president of the Los Angeles Community College District board, against environmental advocate Sarah Rascón to see who will replace Sen. María Elena Durazo, who is moving on to serve on the L.A. County Board of Supervisors.

It’s one of just two L.A. County state Senate races — the other being the 24th District — where both candidates on the ballot are Democrats.

They’re also the only two Senate races in which the California Democratic Party did not endorse a candidate because the members of its endorsement caucus couldn’t reach consensus.

And like the 24th District, the race in the 26th is also among the more expensive legislative races in L.A. County this year.

Between the primary election and mid-October, more than $4.5 million have been spent by outside “independent expenditure” groups on ads, mailers and other expenses in hopes of influencing the outcome of this race.

28th State Senate District

Democratic Sen. Lola Smallwood-Cuevas, who is seeking a second term, is running against Republican businessman Joe Lisuzzo.

30th State Senate District

Sen. Bob Archuleta, a Democrat, wants a third and final term. To do that, he must fend off Republican challenger Araceli Martinez, a small-business owner.

34th State Senate District

Democratic Assemblymember Avelino Valencia and former Placentia City Councilmember Rhonda Shader, a Republican, are vying to replace termed-out Umberg, D-Santa Ana.

36th State Senate District

Republican Sen. Tony Strickland is facing off against former San Clemente City Councilmember Chris Duncan, a Democrat.

34th Assembly District

Big Bear Lake Mayor Randall Putz, a Democrat, is in a runoff with Charles Frederick Hughes, a Republican, after the two advanced from a four-person primary race.

The winner will replace Lackey, R-Palmdale, who is termed out.

39th Assembly District

Assemblymember Juan Carrillo, D-Palmdale, faces Republican challenger Paul Andre Marsh as he seeks a third term.

40th Assembly District

Assemblymember Pilar Schiavo, D-Chatsworth, and Ricky Tracy Hayes II, a Republican entrepreneur and

businessman, are facing off after advancing out of a four-person primary race.

Schiavo was first elected in 2022 and is seeking a third term.

41st Assembly District

First-term Democratic Assemblymember John Harabedian is up against Republican Adam Christopher Vena, a sanitation employee. The two automatically advanced to the general election since they were the only two to run in the primary.

42nd Assembly District

Agoura Hills Councilmember Deborah Klein Lopez, a Democrat, and small-business owner Ted Nordblum, a Republican, are running against each other after advancing out of a three-person primary race.

The winner will replace termed out Irwin, D-Thousand Oaks, who is running for a U.S. House seat being vacated by retiring Rep. Julia Brownley.

43rd Assembly District

Democratic Assemblymember Celeste Rodriguez faces off again against Republican Ricardo Benitez, a plumber and electrical contractor, who was her lone challenger in the primary.

44th Assembly District

Assemblymember Nick Schultz, a Democrat, seeks a second term as he goes toe to toe with Republican Carolyn Daniels, an independent contractor. The two advanced from a three-person primary contest.

46th Assembly District

Democratic Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel, who is seeking a fifth term, will go toe to toe again with his only challenger in the primary, Republican Tracey Schroeder, who is a teacher.

The two also squared off two years ago.

48th Assembly District

Assemblymember Blanca Rubio, a Democrat first elected in 2016, wants a sixth and final term. She faces off again against her sole challenger in the primary, Republican Dan Tran, a real estate businessman whom Rubio beat two years ago.

49th Assembly District

Assemblymember Mike Fong, a Democrat first elected in a special election in February 2022, is up against Republican Long “David” Liu, the chief executive of The Liu Law Firm. The two also ran against each other two years ago.

51st Assembly District

Assemblymember Rick Chavez Zbur, who was first elected in 2022, and challenger Colin Hernandez, a digital communications strategist and fellow Democrat, will go head-to-head after advancing from a five-person primary race.

52nd Assembly District

Democratic Assemblymember Jessica Caloza seeks a second term in this rematch with musician Andrea Lee Anderson, a Republican and the only person to challenge the incumbent in the primary.

53rd Assembly District

Assemblymember Michelle Rodriguez, a Democrat seeking a second term, faces off again against her only challenger in the primary, Republican Rafaela Romero, a special education aide.

54th Assembly District

Assemblymember Mark Gonzalez, a Democrat seeking a second term, is running unopposed.

55th Assembly District

Democratic Assemblymember Isaac Bryan, first elected in 2021, faces school social worker Ashley Brown, a fellow Democrat, after the two advanced from a four-person primary race.

56th Assembly District

Democratic Assemblymember Lisa Calderon, who was first elected in 2020, faces off again against her only challenger in the primary, Republican Jessica Martinez, a retired teacher.

57th Assembly District

Democratic Assemblymember Sade Elhawary, hoping for a second term, will face off against Republican Constance Jewel Menzies, an in-home care provider who was also Elhawary's only challenger in the primary.

61st Assembly District

Assemblymember Tina McKinnor, a Democrat first elected in 2022, is running unopposed.

62nd Assembly District

Democratic Assemblymember José Luis Solache, who is seeking a second term, is up against Republican Paul Irving Jones, a retired Marine. The two also ran against each other two years ago.

64th Assembly District

Assemblymember Blanca Pacheco, a Democrat, is being challenged by Republican Raul Ortiz Jr., a pest control manager.

65th Assembly District

Compton school board member Ayanna Davis, a Democrat, is facing off against public school teacher Lydia Gutiérrez, a Republican, after the two advanced from a six-person primary race.

The winner will replace termed-out Gipson, D-Carson, who is running for a seat on the state Board of Equalization.

66th Assembly District

Rancho Palos Verdes Mayor Paul Seo and Palos Verdes Peninsula Unified school board President Sara Deen are going toe to toe after the two advanced from a six-person primary race.

The winner will succeed termed-out Muratsuchi, D-Torrance.

With no incumbent running, this year’s Democrat-versus-Democrat race has turned what has typically been a sleepy race for this district into one where voters are being inundated with television or digital ads, mailers or text messages on a daily basis.

67th Assembly District

Republican Paulo Morales, a U.S. Marshals Service special deputy, and Cerritos City Councilmember Mark Pulido, a Democrat, are facing off after advancing from the primary, where six candidates ran to replace Quirk-Silva, D-Fullerton.

Pulido edged out Ada Briceño, co-president of Unite Here Local 11 and the former chair of the Orange County Democratic Party, to secure his spot in the runoff.

69th Assembly District

Assemblymember Josh Lowenthal, who is seeking a third term, is running again against fellow Democrat Carolyn Essex, a policy analyst, and Lowenthal’s only challenger in the primary.

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